

Erin N. King

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EDUCATION

Master of Human-Computer Interaction (MHCI) | Iowa State University | GPA: 4.0 | Dec 2025

B.S. Cognitive Science (HCI & AI) & B.A. Intensive Psychology | UC Santa Cruz | Honors | 2022

SKILLS

Research: Usability Testing, Think-Aloud Protocol, Semi-Structured Interviews, Thematic Analysis, Contextual Inquiry, Qualitative Coding (Taguette), Content Analysis, Cognitive Engineering, Field Studies, Participant Recruitment, CITI Ethics

Design: Figma, Miro, Mural, Information Architecture, UX Writing

Tools: HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Shopify (Liquid), AI-Assisted Code (Lovable/Claude), Qualtrics, WCAG 2.2

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Web Development & UX Consultant | Independent Contractor | Mar 2024 – Present

- Led Shopify theme migration for an inherited storefront, preserving custom functionality and resolving post-migration technical debt.
- Built dynamic product linking with Shopify Metaobjects and trained the client team to maintain the feature independently.
- Applied WCAG 2.2 standards within client constraints, including a promotional banner that pauses on hover and decluttered copy across key pages.
- Designed and built an event landing site on a platform chosen so the client could self-maintain after handoff; set up SEO keeping the site at or near the top of Google results for its primary event queries; supported event cycles drawing 3,000+ sessions and 100+ ticket orders in a 30-day window.
- Conducted a pro bono website accessibility audit, identified usability barriers, and presented findings with prioritized recommendations.

Accessibility & Advocacy Internships | Santa Cruz, CA | Jan 2022 – Jun 2022

- **Monarch Independent Living:** Produced accessible educational media, including cooking tutorial videos and custom-designed games, for adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities, prioritizing cognitive ease and comprehension.
- **Laurel Street Center:** Implemented person-centered care and developed virtual learning programs adapted to individual needs, supporting consumer independence and community inclusion.

RESEARCH & DESIGN PROJECTS

Storytelling in Disability Spaces on Reddit / *Qualitative Research, Thematic Analysis*

- Conducted five semi-structured interviews and applied inductive thematic analysis to synthesize user narratives into design recommendations for inclusive digital spaces.

AI Transparency & User Trust / *Qualitative Research, Human-AI Interaction*

- Conducted a qualitative study on how users evaluate ChatGPT credibility through iterative prompting sessions; found that structural and tonal cues drive trust judgments more than source citations.

Distracted Walking: Urban Pedestrian Behavior

- Collaborated on a distributed research team across three cities to analyze mobile device impact on safety; synthesized observational data to map urban navigation patterns.

Hades: Cognitive Load & Expert Performance / *Cognitive Engineering*

- Measured how attentional overload affects expert and novice performance under varying task demands, applying cognitive engineering frameworks to interface design implications.

EduFlow: Digital Transformation & Design Systems

- Developed a scalable Atomic Design system with accessibility built in; utilized AI-assisted coding tools (Lovable/Claude) to deploy a functional web application.

CERTIFICATIONS

- CITI Program: Social/Behavioral Research – Basic Course (Human Research Ethics)
- Google UX Design Specialization | IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner | IBM Team Essentials for AI